



Note: The presence or absence of the trailing slash in the source/destination path is very important; it makes quite a difference to how files are copied. In the above command, the trailing slash in the source, `/home/user/Folder1/` means that the *contents* (files and sub-folders) inside *Folder1* are to be copied to the destination folder. Without the trailing slash, *rsync* first creates the *Folder1* folder at the destination, and then copies *Folder1*'s contents into that new folder. Always keep this in mind, else you can end up with quite a mess to sort out if you're backing up two or three project folders, like (in `/home/ankit/Projects`) *projA*, *projB*, *projC*. Or if, for example, your *rsync* commands are as follows:

```
rsync --recursive --delete /home/ankit/Projects/projA/ /media/
BACKUP/currentprojects
rsync --recursive --delete /home/ankit/Projects/projB/ /media/
BACKUP/currentprojects
rsync --recursive --delete /home/ankit/Projects/projC /media/
BACKUP/currentprojects
```

Now, in the *currentprojects* folder on the backup drive, you will have a folder *projC*, containing that project's files—but the files and sub-folders from the *projA* and *projB* folders will be mixed together in the *currentprojects* folder, not inside individual *projA* and *projB* folders... and this will be because

you wrongly used the trailing slash for those folders. If you have to recover files from this backup, imagine the mess and confusion, and the effort required to sort things out!

GUI tools

There are a number of GUI tools available for *rsync*, most of which obviously cannot match the flexibility provided by the command-line itself. Still, some of the tools, like *Grsync* and *Gadmin-Rsync*, do a good job of implementing the basic functionality. Another really good application based on the *rsync*, *cron* and *diff* commands is *Back in Time*, which resembles the Time Machine feature of Apple's Mac OS. It provides more sophisticated features, and an interface understandable even by non-geeks.

In conclusion, we can say that *rsync* is a simple, yet really powerful application, which when used with tools like *cron* can provide flexibility and performance comparable with complex and even enterprise back-up tools.  **END**

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